

Samsung Galaxy S26

This phone is almost perfect... almost

For years, Samsung has been refining its Galaxy S series lineup, and with the standard Galaxy S26 model, that approach is even clearer. And this year, more than just refining, Samsung has also made a couple of changes. First, it has dropped the 128GB variant completely. Yes, the Galaxy S26 now starts at 256GB in the base variant, officially, which sounds great on paper. But do note it also brings a Rs 7,000 price jump compared to the Galaxy S25. Because I am not sure how many of you folks noticed, but last year, after the S25 went official, Samsung later introduced a 128GB variant specifically for India, so that it could be more accessible for buyers.

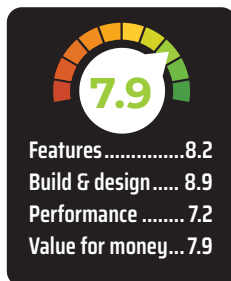
To give you the exact cost, the Galaxy S26 in India starts at Rs 87,999 for the base 12GB + 256GB option, while the 512GB variant is priced in India at Rs 1,07,999.

Personally speaking, getting the 256GB variant as the entry point on a flagship phone is always a good move. What's even better is that I'm someone who loves compact phones. Something I can comfortably use with one hand, and that's where the Galaxy S26 fits perfectly into my lifestyle.

DESIGN

For me, Samsung has nailed the design this time. Don't worry, I don't mean to imply that the Galaxy S26 is dramatically different from its predecessors, as the device still carries that compact flagship feel. It's lightweight, slim and easy to use with one hand. At just 7.2mm thick, it looks and feels very sleek, and this time, Samsung managed to increase the battery size by 300mAh

₹87,999



compared to the Galaxy S25.

Overall, the Galaxy S26 feels very premium in hand. It has an aluminium frame, and both the front and back glass are protected by the Gorilla Glass Victus 2. The matte finish on the black looks clean, although it still attracts fingerprints, so I

had to wipe it quite often.

DISPLAY

I can easily say, this is one department where Samsung never disappoints, and the Galaxy S26 continues that streak.

You get a 6.3-inch FHD+ LTPO display with an adaptive 1-120Hz refresh rate. Samsung calls it the Dynamic AMOLED 2X panel. Compared to the S25's 6.2-inch panel, this one is slightly larger. Also, right from the start, you can tell that this is a gorgeous screen. It is sharp, the colours pop and contrast levels are excellent.

Outdoors visibility is also excellent. I have been using the Galaxy S26 in Delhi's summer, and the display remained visible throughout. I never had to squint my eyes to see the display.

In the brightness test at our Digit Test Labs, the display reached a peak brightness of 2650 nits, which is very impressive.

In the Calman colour test, it recorded an average Delta E of 2.2. Now, this is not class-leading because I've seen displays that got an average Delta E of as low as 0.6. But beyond the numbers, in real-world usage, the display looks bright and crisp, and that's what really matters.

Also, in the Colour gamut test, it covers 99.9 per cent of the sRGB colour space, which again is excellent to say the least.

PERFORMANCE

The Samsung Galaxy S26 is the first phone in the world to come with a 2nm chipset, the Exynos 2600. In terms of raw power,

this is a flagship processor without a doubt. It delivers strong benchmark numbers, and we'll get to that in a moment. In everyday usage, too, it feels fast and responsive.

In terms of managing the thermals, it does a good job most of the time for most tasks. You see, while playing games on the Galaxy S26 for extended periods, the phone tends to warm up. For instance, after around 30 minutes of gaming, you can feel the rise in temperature on the back. And this is something that also showed up in the CPU throttling test, where the phone scored a 57 per cent stability. This means that, while the phone is capable of handling the load, it does so at the cost of consistency to keep the heat in check.

However, other benchmark scores were much better. In Antutu, it scored 3.1 million, which is great. In Geekbench 6, it scored 3,137 in single-core and crossed the 10,000 mark in multi-core score. In the 3DMark Wildlife Extreme